

WELCOME TO THE DISCWORLD

A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world

TONE: dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

THE DISC

A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
 - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
 - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
 - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
 - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
 - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.

YOU ARE A VAMPIRE

- **What you are:** an intelligent undead being, most famously from Überwald (think fictional Transylvania). You might be **born** a vampire into a vampire family, or **made** by a bite, though vampires generally prefer not to. You're pale, skinny, very fast and powerful, and can float or turn into bats and other animals.
- **Weaknesses:** the traditional ones: garlic, holy water, holy symbols, stakes, decapitation, fire, and direct sunlight, which turns you to ash (heavy clothes and a broad-brimmed hat help). A drop of blood brings even a pile of ash back.
- **Blood:** you have a "deficit of hemoglobin", but your craving is more of an addiction than a diet. Blood doesn't need to be fresh, or even human.
- **Temperance:** many modern vampires join the **Überwald League of Temperance** (the "Black Ribboners"), giving up human blood and swapping the craving for coffee, photography or politics.
- **Stereotypes:** *cool, poised and stylish*, especially if natural-born (bitten vampires have to work at it). Old-school ones are meticulous and resist modern ideas, while the young rebel with ratty jumpers and ordinary names.
- **Names:** grand names that grow over the centuries as titles pile up, often with a *von* (Sally von Humpeding, Count de Magpyr, Lady Margolotta), or plain and modern (John, Melinda).



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